BMC ELECTION

The New Big Brother

The BJP-led Mahayuti prevails despite the Thackeray reunion in the Mumbai civic battle

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ON JANUARY 15, MUMBAI VOTED to decide the fate of the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC)—India's richest civic body, with an annual budget of nearly Rs 74,500 crore. This election was fought amid sharp polarisation—between Marathi and non-Marathi voters, and across religious lines. In a rare turn driven by political necessity, estranged cousins Uddhav Thackeray and Raj Thackeray reunited after two decades. The Bharatiya Janata Party, meanwhile, ran a localised campaign, relying on state and city leadership rather than national heavyweights—Prime Minister Narendra Modi notably stayed away from the trail. The strategy paid off: the BJP-led Mahayuti alliance won over half of the seats, with the BJP emerging as the single largest party.

MUMBAI'S POWER MAP: WHO TOOK THE SPOILS



BJP

It has increased its BMC tally by seven seats over the previous election, rising from 82 to 89 and emerging as the single largest party. In a long-running grudge match with the Thackerays, the result is a clear feather in the cap for Maharashtra CM **Devendra Fadnavis**

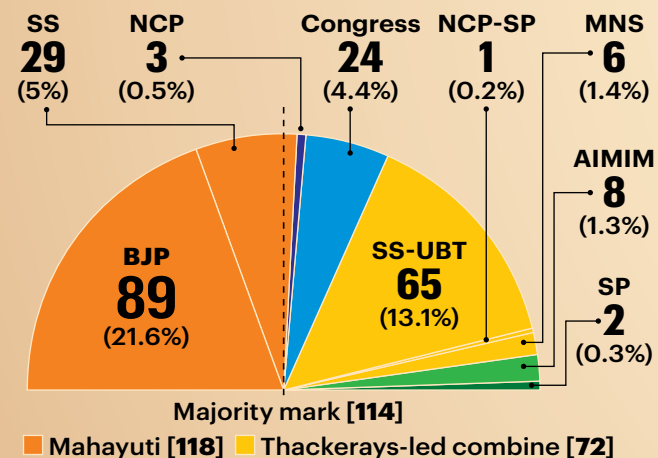


SHIV SENA

Though its performance fell short of expectations—winning just 29 of the 91 seats it contested—the **Eknath Shinde**-led Sena holds the keys to power in the BMC after BJP failed to secure a majority on its own. The deputy CM is driving a hard bargain for a larger share of power, including the mayoral post



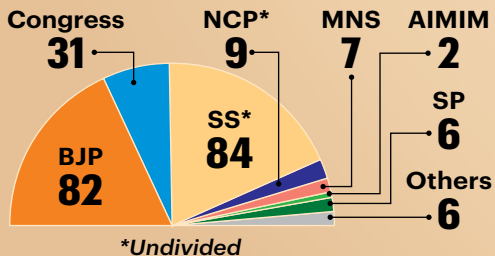
2026 RESULTS



Elected members **227**

***Seats won,** vote share in ( )*

2017 RESULTS



**Undivided*

BJP=Bharatiya Janata Party; SS=Shiv Sena; SS(UBT)=Shiv Sena-Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray; MNS=Maharashtra Navnirman Sena; NCP=Nationalist Congress Party; NCP-SP=Nationalist Congress Party-Sharadchandra Pawar; AIMIM=All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen; SP=Samajwadi Party